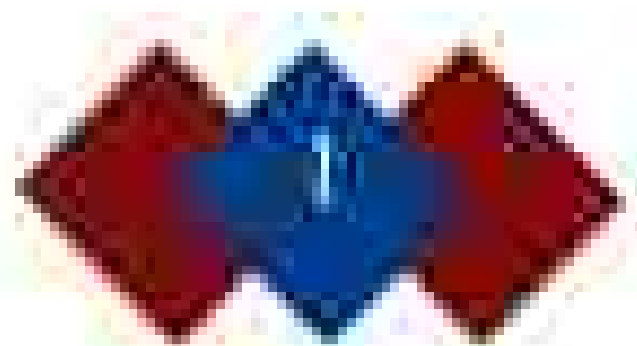




The Turkish Revolution and the Founding of Modern Turkey

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Abstract

In the 20th century, the Ottoman Empire, which helped the world's evolution, experienced a period of transformation in which social, political, and cultural changes were found. The Turkish Revolution, led by Mustafa Kemal Atatürk, began following the collapse of the Ottoman Empire in 1922. The revolution represented a shift from traditional imperial rule to a modern nation following nationalism and secularism, establishing a republic in 1923. Atatürk's reforms reshaped Turkey's identity and contributed to critical professional roles. This research paper examines the pathogenesis behind the revolution that transformed Turkey's political and social environment, and how the philosophy of nationalism, secularism, and progressivism changed Turkey in terms of education, culture, legal restructuring, development, and its place within the global community. It will also discuss the Ottoman Empire, the Turkish War of Independence, the new Atatürk law, transition to the republic, and modernization, and the current political state within the "AKP era", showing the fight for nationalism and global cooperation.

Keywords: Ottoman Empire, Mustafa Kemal Atatürk, Turkey, Nationalism, Turkish War of Independence,

1827, Revolution, modernism, Republican People's Party (1907)

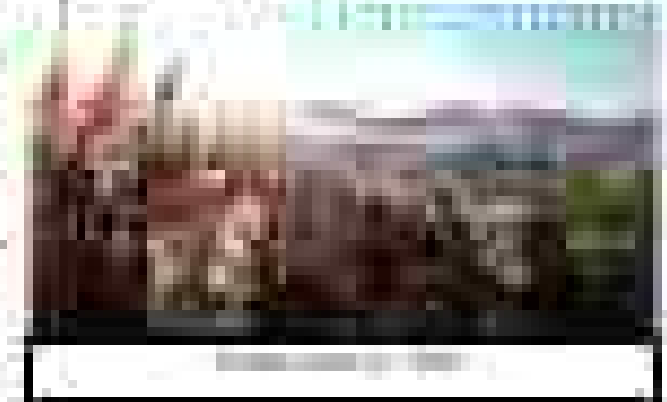
Introduction:

The Turkish Revolution, which marked the beginning of modern Turkey and the end of the long-lasting Ottoman Empire, was one of the most influential movements in Middle Eastern history. This transformation was led by one man: Mustafa Kemal Atatürk, who was determined to establish a new, modern state. With his vision and ideas, he reshaped the old Ottoman institutions and policies in the past and made groundbreaking changes to modern Turkey and Turkey in society. These changes affected the everyday lives of Turkish citizens. By founding the Republican People's Party and rejecting the influence of religion, Atatürk aimed to turn Turkey into a 19th-century industrialized state. Furthermore, the introduction of western culture in Turkey was supported by Mustafa Kemal's passage in 1923 of a Western-inspired constitution, called the Constitution, which advocated for women's rights. He was not satisfied by ancient laws. This led to Turkey being the country providing the electricity in Europe and the Middle East. (Ulusoylu, 2024). With the new Turkey came new legislations and new European standards. It had started to become acquainted with international laws, such as civil codes, modern language, and numerous laws, including which have become laws from the European Convention and changed the new national identity based on legislation and regulation.



The Ottoman Empire (1299-1918)

The Ottoman Empire, one of the largest, strongest, and longest-lasting civilizations, shaped the world map of the 15th century and beyond. It was strong in many aspects, including science, arts, economy, and language. One of the key Ottoman (OTOMAN) achievements included its large impact on the 15th and 16th centuries. The empire expanded north from the borders of modern-day Turkey, reaching modern-day Hungary, Greece, even Vienna, and Ukraine, all the way to the Arabian Gulf of the whole Middle East, reaching the west of North Africa and some parts of the Arabian Peninsula. It originally began around 1299 against the Byzantine (Byzantine) Empire, as it served its main purpose of fighting the Byzantine Empire. Until the 17th century, it had a rivalry with the Safavid Empire, which was a powerful state in modern-day Iran. The Ottomans had a project for growing a new empire loyal to its subjects and cultural roots, which peaked when the Ottoman Empire reached its peak after a long reign. This spread of power from the Ottomans to the Safavids was the end of the Ottoman Empire (1918).



After World War I began the end of the Ottoman Empire, many empires followed its footsteps and expanded the region further. Over 150 years later, the empire had reached its peak, with Mahmud II as its last ruler. Mahmud II's accomplishments were one of the most important in the empire's history, as he was able to reform the long-standing "Janissary Corps", Constantinople, Turkey. He gathered a large army of around 10,000 soldiers and 500 ships to besiege the city, in which the last Sultan, Mehmet III, was killed. The 55-day siege had surprised the authorities of the Ottoman Empire to state, and the city of Constantinople finally fell in May of 1809 after it withstood many attacks over centuries (Peters, 2024). This gave the Ottoman Empire military power and reputation, which lasted for another 100 years. However, that strong battle is their own culture and

separately put the Ottomans at risk as they attempted to avoid any changes happening in the new European world. With many attempts to shape new parts of neighboring countries and with the various crises, the empire failed to stand as it went through many difficulties, such as Habsburg Hungary, Austria, Russia, and Prussia. The final blow fully destroyed the centuries-old state, plagued with Ottoman losses in World War I, which also ended the post-war consequences, which destroyed the empire for good. The fall of the Ottoman Empire in 1912 gave a new man, Mustafa Kemal Atatürk, the opportunity to establish the nation and begin work with the Republic of Turkey (Homer and Singer, 2012:4).

Atatürk - the Father

"Father of the Foundation of Turkish Republic" - M.K. Atatürk

Mustafa Kemal Atatürk, born on the 19th of May in 1881 in Thessaloniki (now Thessaloniki of modern-day Greece) was a child of parents coming from old Turkish families, marrying his life with his nation. Atatürk completed his education in Mekteb-i Mülkiye (Imperial High School) and Mekteb-i Felsefe ve Tıp (Imperial College) in Istanbul (1902 - 1904). He graduated as a lieutenant in 1902 and continued his education in Turkey, graduating with the rank of captain. During his journey to becoming the founder of the republic of Turkey, Atatürk had several roles in government-related positions. He firstly worked as the Chief Spokesman of the House and the Head of the Government in the Turkish Grand National Assembly before becoming president, which was one of the important steps in the founding of the Turkish Republic. Following the formation of the Turkish National Assembly, many conflicts took place as the empire was not so independent. The last conflict, the Battle of Sakarya led to the promotion of Mustafa Kemal to the rank of Field Marshal and granted him the title of Gazi (the Victorious Fighter), earning him much honor and title, Gazi Mustafa Kemal Paşa. The last declaration of the Republic was made on the 29th of October 1923. Mustafa Kemal Atatürk was elected as the first President of the Turkish Republic. One of the most significant reforms made by Atatürk was Social Reforms, as Women were given equal rights with men, a Revolution in Religion and Culture took place. The national law was implemented, education, press and legal rules were established, and the international relations, laws and constitution were aligned. Other reforms such as national reforms, educational and cultural reforms, and commercial reforms, took place. These reforms and constitution didn't see all in the revolution of Turkey (as) in current markets were but also felt by the people of Turkey. Having been forgotten, Atatürk was creating a legacy of unconditional love for him that helped for over a century. Citizens of Culture and Tradition of the Republic of Turkey. Looking at his social and personal life, Atatürk was married to Laila Hanım for a short period and had no biological children from her. However, he adopted several daughters and a son due to his very young child of his to take care and become the first Turkish Attorney General (2022). Additionally, one of his adopted daughters (Zehra Gülsu) became the first female fighter in the world.



The Founding of a Modern Nation

The 1920s were an essential period for the people of modern-day Turkey, where they could see that indeed society's traditions are essential factors that could be recognisably worldwide. The Turkish Congress of Ankara (TCGA) has revealed that before the war broke out, the Ottoman empire struggled in the Turkish National War of Independence for independence in 1919, as studies have shown through Kemal's account of the Ottoman Empire.

From the Ottoman government and the Allied powers. This led to the powerful movement against the Ottoman Sultan on May 22, showing that Turks could not accept foreign subjugation and hoped for national sovereignty, signalling the beginning of the national liberation struggle. "I have no doubts against the long-lasting empire was passionate, and they were willing to do anything to gain freedom, as the 'liberty of [their] father' was to be won by the nation's persistence and will." After a year of hard effort by the distinguished leaders and the people, the Turkish Grand National Assembly declared the nation no longer a vassal state in November 1st, 1922. Ankara's year later on October 29th, 1922, Ankara was declared the capital of the new Turkish Republic, with Mustafa Kemal elected as its first and president Çankır. Mustafa Kemal's plan in 1926. Çankır was a new nation was established, as he believed every of the empire's long-lasting traditions that linked personal freedom, while also maintaining the cultural values of the empire. The leader managed to create a community safe for his people within and outside the physical borders, as he changed the language to use the Latin alphabet rather than the old Arabic script, which led to even higher literacy rates. The law was changed into something worthy was script, where everyone can live with civil values, such as the abolition of polygamy and Islamic law offered "women's emancipation [to her] throughout". Furthermore, Atatürk's efforts were not limited as he enlarged the country's legal system, and economic foundation (Kutluoğlu, 2020).



A secular government and the Republic's constitution:

The establishment of a secular government in Turkey was that from of the republic's constitution and a fundamental aspect of Mustafa Kemal Atatürk's vision, following the collapse of the Ottoman Empire. The TCGA Committee initiated a significant shift in the nation's values and principles, establishing secularism as a constitutional principle. It was stated in the belief that Islam should not play a public role in government, as it is a personal choice and not something to be governmental. The new part of Atatürk's secular vision transformation Turkey and align it with Western ideals, possibly identifying it with the new European Union (EU), promoting a national identity that diverged from the traditional Islamic past (Kutlu, 2019). The reforms included the abolition of religious courts and schools, the abolishing of the caliphate, and the implementation of a civil legal framework that replaced Sharia law with European-inspired legislation. Atatürk's reforms aimed to establish a government where citizens were private citizens, free to exercise a society based on rationality and scientific thought, which he viewed as essential for national progress (Kutlu, 2019). This transformation not only reshaped the relationship between state and religion but also laid the foundation for Turkey's unique modern identity within the Muslim world.



Mustafa Kemal Atatürk

The Birth of a New Language:

The Turkish Republic underwent significant changes after its formation from the long-lasting Ottoman Empire, especially as the nation reformed its language in 1928. This major reform faced both praise and criticism

challenges for women in the nation's future in the long run. Before the Modern Turkish language was established, the high class of the empire used Ottoman Turkish, a combination of Turkish, Arabic, and Persian influences. Since the ordinary people had little knowledge of this language, there was a great linguistic barrier between the two classes. The public found difficulty in adopting it as the language. As the history now changed the whole empire was only 10%, with most lower class within the Muslim community (Tos, 2011).

However, before the formation of Ottoman Turkish, there were early attempts to foster national identity and bring the people together by speaking the same language. For example, İsmail Hakkı and Nispet Ziya led the



Figure 1.1: Language Movement

New Language Movement in the years 1908-1918 and shaped ideas about the Turkish identity and the new "Turkish language." According to Aydılı (2006), "Turkish and his followers" initiated the replacement of Ottoman Turkish of foreign pronunciation and with Arabic and Persian words, while they wanted to retain those languages that they considered very Turkish." These changes were believed to reform the Turkish identity while also keeping it fresh, as the Ottoman Turkish language was believed to be imperial and absorbing foreign words even more to the blurring of the roots. Atatürk's ideas influenced the later reforms in the Republic. It was after the Turkish War of Independence.

Known as the "Language Revolution", Mustafa Kemal Atatürk's reforms were believed significant after the nation's establishment in 1923. Like Ottoman, the new language retained its retention of Arabic and Persian elements, incorporation of grammar, and adoption of a new writing style. The Turkish Language Institute was soon created to establish and standardize the language, as many visible changes occurred over time (Kadıcıoğlu, 2018). One of the most changes of the language which was the change to Alphabet, as Turkey has been associated with the Latin Alphabet rather than the traditional Arabic script. According to Yılmaz (2011), "Through surveys in the Milli Mecmua, Osman Seyran's manuscripts was significantly – from 1% before the reform to 31% after a decade." This reflected the positive impact of the reformed language as many people had adapted to the language easily. In short, establishing education and communication of Modern Turkish became a rallying force that established and developed Turkey's national identity. The big reforms also symbolized a nation born, Christian traditions, aligning with Atatürk's vision of a secular and progressive republic.

Women's Rights in the Republic

For centuries, Turkish women lacked rights as a result of the Ottoman Empire's rule. The formation of the republic was a revolutionary step for women, as civil law was adopted in 1926, granting women's rights to vote and eligibility by 1935. The new civil law was a practical translation of the Swiss civil code, which created several rights for women, specifically property, which made Turkish women support the idea of women's rights. In 1933, the creation of the National Assembly gave women, making up 4.5% of all seats. With several social movements, the West saw Turkish women as the future of the time, with British women protesting for their rights by comparing themselves to Turkish women. The secularist women had refused to date foreignly. Atatürk, the reformer, such a good country. In the same year, the Turkish Women's Union (TWU), which merged the Ottoman and republican women's movements, was asked to shut down. Atatürk stated that women had "full equal value with men," and their movement was for the TWU. This was the end of the women's movement for 90 years to come, where activities remained but no



active revolution. In 1978, the issue of 'gender inequality' started to surface. Several women then came to work where the men were asked to disengage 'house work' and other domestic or domestic-like job in the name of protecting the family. This all was cancelled in 2004 when women regained their rights (State Council). On the 1st of July 2011, Turkey officially withdrew supporting the National Convention, which suggested a large number of women across the country.

The National Policy and Economic History

The Republic of Turkey was uniquely located in two continents, Europe and Asia. This gave the nation a big responsibility in the field of global modern politics. After the establishment of the Ottoman Empire, foreign policy underwent many significant changes. Starting from World War II, Turkey adopted a neutralist policy to avoid involvement in global conflict as they had military and economic limitations. They had several difficulties in their economy and defense, which made it very tough to protect the country, to show attack and participate in the war. This was because of the 'emphasis on domestic economic transformation through the first five-year industrialization plan'.



Additionally, as a complex nation, Turkey's primary aim was to develop which would involve an alliance with Britain and France. According to Hale (2014), "Turkey's foreign policy was closely tied to that of Germany due to her efforts to protect from Britain, France, and other Western countries against a significant reduction of its exports and imports." This meant Turkey had to carefully balance its relations with both the Associated Allied powers. After World War II, Turkey joined NATO in 1952, pulling from its neutral stance to active alignment with the Western bloc during the Cold War. However, the Soviet Union had previously threatened Turkey with control of the Dardanelles Straits and the formation of the COMECON group of countries. Turkey saw this threatening as a hostile response that could result in its protection against any Soviet aggression (NATO, 2019). Furthermore, when Yugoslavia established the Non-aligned Party during the Cold War, Turkey opposed the concept of non-alignment, believing it could jeopardize its independence of countries having economic relations. At the Bandung Conference in 1955, Turkey represented the West and its interests, 'expressing its opinion against the idea of non-alignment.' Once its location in Europe, Turkey was anticipated to join the European Union upon its formation. However, joining the EU further complicated Turkey's position as it required alignment with the Western Europe and Security Policy and the stability of the EU's requirements. Thus, Turkey was hesitant to partner with the EU until some other critical steps such as Cyprus, Ireland, and Malta (NATO, 2019) to complete. Turkey's efforts to join any alliance power like NATO, the EU, or NATO were hindered by its neutralist policies and strategic stance in its foreign policy, during and after World War II and the Cold War.

AKP and the Islamic Ideology: RTT's Turkey

The AKP (Akademi Halkların Partisi) or the Justice and Development Party is a political party with an Islamic agenda representing Turkey's secular Constitution that came to power in the general election of 2002. Led by Abdullah Gül and Recep Tayyip Erdoğan (RTT), the AK Party (in Turkish also meaning "justice" or "right") is a domestic, conservative, internationalist movement. Since its rise, it has been a rather successful party that won the majority of votes until the early 2010s. According to Hale (2014), it showed an overall RTT (Recep Tayyip Erdoğan) was first elected as the mayor of Istanbul in 1994 and was re-elected in 1998 for leading religious leaders after winning a power that composed majority in Turkey's transition to democracy and the formation of an army, which had first re-



major in Turkey. As a result, he was disqualified from serving as parliament member, a constitutional amendment in 2007 removed his disqualification, as President Ahmet Necdet Sezer asked him to form a new government, which he took office in 2008 as prime minister. In August of 2014, Erdogan was elected as president for the first time. On July 15th, 2016, Erdogan survived a military coup attempt, which is a very famous military personnel coup attempt in Ankara and Istanbul and related facilities, including police force stations and bridges. They accused Erdogan and the AKP of weakening democracy and sabotaging the rule of law and constitution in Turkey. Later on, by spreading presidential powers, Erdogan's economic policies coincided with IMF, partly helped against Turkish debt and inflationary pressure, leading Turkey into recession. When the lira had lost a quarter of its value, and the slow down in economic growth continued into 2018. The decline in the value of the Lira and the overall Turkish economy remains to this day. In 2017 he became a single candidate in the Reform Union. When the 2017 election, the country showed great admiration towards Kemal Kerdaroglu, who led the opposition party CHP (Hürriyetler, 2017). However, Erdogan still won the elections and is currently serving his second term of presidency until 2023, as per the constitution. All in all, AKP caused significant economic losses and made the country internationally vulnerable.

Conclusion

In conclusion, the Ottoman Empire's evolution into modern Turkey was a game-changer not only for the Turks but for the entire world. With new laws and a switch to a secular government, Turkey began to adapt to Europe, aligning with their standards in hopes of being admitted into the European Union, then known as the EC. As new languages emerged, replacing a new alphabet and new rules, serving as another way of adapting to Europe. Atatürk created the modernized the state rights system, which was another push for Turkey into the new century and modernized the rights system in presidential and parliamentary structures.

After Atatürk's death, Islam began to surface in the nation unknown modernization. Political instability, military coups, and tensions between secularism and religious conservatism created a complex landscape for the country. As Turkey sought to keep pace with European standards, conflicts arose regarding human rights, freedom of speech, and political liberties. Turkey's own struggles, Turkey remained a significant force in international geopolitics, balancing its rich cultural heritage with the pressures of modernization.

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